

Ward Walton

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EXPERIENCE

Sportradar

September 2023 - Present

Broadcast Research Analyst

- Specialize in data analysis for player and team performance across major U.S. sports: NFL, NBA, NHL, MLB, college basketball, and college football.
- Contribute to high-profile sports broadcasts, including the NFL Playoffs, Super Bowl, and March Madness, by providing information for unique and insightful graphics and commentary.
- Utilize advanced SQL queries to access and analyze historical sports data, support client inquiries, enhance television broadcasts, and use data to tell a compelling story.

Sedgwick Claims Management Services

May 2022 – April 2023

Data Scientist

- Completed end-to-end data science projects, combining skills in Dataiku, SQL, and R.
- Responsibilities included data preparation and cleaning, model development and production. With a focus on enhancing predictive accuracy and operational efficiency.
- Created and implemented a fraudulent claim detection model using unsupervised learning techniques as well as a model for predicting large loss claims.

Data Science Intern

- Developed a model to identify high-risk workers' compensation claims, streamlining the prioritization process for claims examiners and enhancing the speed of claim settlements.
- Improved model accuracy and interpretability over previous implementations, supporting more effective resource allocation

Syracuse University Men's Lacrosse | Syracuse, NY

March 2022 - June 2022

Data Analytics & Sport Science Intern

- Identified patterns of player overexertion to inform and adjust practice strategies and load management.
- Managed data collection and analysis from wearable VXSport devices.
- Designed and maintained daily dashboards visualizing biometric data, enhancing player performance and reducing risk of injury.

PROJECTS

NBA MVP Prediction Model

- Used machine learning techniques in Python to forecast NBA Most Valuable Player award winners. Achieved an accuracy rate of 86% for past seasons, and correctly predicted the winner of the 2024 award.

Does Intercollegiate Sports Success Affect University Enrollment Outcomes?

- Explored the impact of NCAA football success on university enrollment, assessing the effects of premier bowl game appearances, and overall television exposure on applicant numbers and acceptance rates. Revealed that on-field success and TV exposure significantly increased applications, particularly at smaller schools, with a more pronounced effect on male applicants.

Developing a Predictive Model for College Lacrosse

- Analyzed over 3,500 NCAA Division I men's lacrosse games from 2014-2021. Demonstrated that offensive and defensive efficiency, along with faceoff percentage, drive the biggest impact on game outcomes.

Positional Clustering in Men's College Lacrosse

- Conducted an analysis of NCAA Division I men's college lacrosse players identifying seven distinct player roles, used findings to enhance strategic team building and game preparation. Found that players in three clusters significantly contributed to team offensive success and NCAA tournament qualifications.

EDUCATION

Syracuse University | Syracuse, NY

2018 – 2022

Bachelor of Science - Sport Analytics, Economics

- GPA: 3.76
- Falk College Dean's List – 7/8 semesters
- Omicron Delta Epsilon Economic Honor Society
- Berlin Sport Analytics Scholar
- Economics Distinction Program

SKILLS

Python, SQL, R, Excel, Microsoft Office, STATA